



National Recreation Trail Application

Instruction Sheet

Introduction

National Recreation Trails (NRTs) form an important part of the National Trails System. They are not created through Congressional action, but are recognized by Federal secretarial action. Trails associated with the USDA Forest Service are recognized by the appropriate Regional Forester in that agency. All other nominated trails are approved and recognized by the Secretary of the Interior.

To be recognized as an NRT, a trail or trail system must be in place and open to the public. The trail's manager(s) must be able to certify that it will be open for public use for at least the next 10 years. The trail should be designed, constructed, and maintained according to best management practices (in keeping with the trail's uses). The trail must comply with all applicable land use plans and environmental laws. In addition, all public and private landowners whose property is crossed by the trail must have been notified about this nomination and must provide written consent to accompany this application.

American Trails, a nationwide nonprofit trails group based in California, maintains the official NRT website and web-accessible database. The benefits of becoming an NRT are numerous – the prestige of being part of the National Trails System, heightened promotion and visibility, a reward for concerted citizen action, and increased eligibility for project funding.

Upon designation, the information you provide in the following application may be used to set up the NRT web page for your trail. To view existing NRT web pages, please visit the NRT website, www.americantrails.org/nationalrecreationtrails. Thank you for your interest in the National Recreation Trail (NRT) program.

The Application Process and Instructions

There are two procedures for National Recreation Trail applications— if your trail is on land administered by, crosses over, or is associated with the US Department of Agriculture (National Forests, National Grasslands, and National Recreation Areas and associated lands) contact the USDA Forest Service NRT Coordinator at (202) 205-1589 for guidelines on their application process. Otherwise follow the Department of the Interior application process below. Please see the NRT website for more details, including a list of current program criteria. If you have any questions as to which process to follow, please call either NRT Coordinator for assistance prior to starting the process.

Application for NRT designation to the Secretary of the Interior requires two components which must be submitted to the Department of the Interior's National Recreation Trail Coordinator **by November 1.**

1. Application Form

The application form (Word file) must be e-mailed to the DOI NRT Coordinator **by November 1.**

2. Supplemental Package

A supplemental package of materials should be submitted to the DOI NRT Coordinator **by November 1**. When possible, provide the supplemental package materials digitally on a CD. The package should include:

- a hard-copy of the signature page (“Certification for Public Use”) with original signature
- a letter of consent from each affected landowner (For land trails, letters of consent are required from all landowners, both public and private, whose property the trail crosses. For a water trail, letters of consent are required from all landowners/managers, both public and private, of access points and landings along the trail, as well as from the owner(s) of the body of water.)
- a map or maps of the trail (Often two maps may be necessary – one to show the trail’s general location and another with the details of the route and associated features.)
- photos of print quality (Digital photos must be 800 kb (300 dpi) or larger.)
- a letter or e-mail of support from the appropriate State Trails Administrator/Coordinator if the trail is a state, local government, or private trail (a list of State Trails Administrators/Coordinators is available at <http://www.fhwa.dot.gov/environment/rectrails/rtpstate.htm>)
- (optional) support letters
- (optional) resolution of support by units of local government (optional)
- (if available) trail brochure
- (if available) trail shapefile or any other geospatial information for GIS/GPS.

Both the application form and the supplemental package together will constitute the NRT application for your trail and must be submitted by the trail’s managing agency, organization, or individual officially responsible for permitting trail use by the November 1 deadline. All U.S. Postal Service mail to Federal offices in Washington DC is irradiated. Therefore, for quickest delivery and to avoid damage to package contents, it is recommended that the supplemental package be shipped (e.g. by FedEx, DHL, etc.) to the DOI NRT Coordinator.

Regional NRT Contacts are available to provide assistance. A list is available at <http://www.americantrails.org/nationalrecreationtrails/ContactsNRT.html>. Interested trail managers should begin the application process in coordination with a Regional NRT Contact as early as possible to ensure submission by the November 1 deadline.

The announcement of trails designated as new NRTs occurs the following June, usually in conjunction with National Trails Day.

For Information and Assistance

If you have questions about the NRT program, or would like the name and contact information for your agency or Regional NRT Contact, please contact the DOI NRT Coordinator.

Department of the Interior
National Recreation Trail Coordinator
National Park Service (Org Code 2220)
1201 Eye Street, NW, 9th Floor, Space #7
Washington, DC 20005
Phone 202-354-6910 Fax 202-371-5179
Website: www.nps.gov/nrt/ or www.americantrails.org/nationalrecreationtrails
Email: Helen_Scully@nps.gov

National Recreation Trail

Department of the Interior

Application for Designation

Trail Name:

Trail Location:

(examples: “In Brandon State Park near Springfield, IA.” or “Railtrail that connects Millerville with Fort Claremont along the south shore of the Blue River northwest of Clark City.”)

Directions to Trail:

(example: “From Springfield, take SR 897 west c. 6 miles to park entrance.” or “Many access points between Tampa and Fort Myers off of US 36.”)

Lat. / Long. of trailhead(s) (if available):

Length of trail open to public use: _____ miles

City(ies)/County(ies)/Township(s) crossed by the trail:

State(s):

U.S. Congressional District(s):

Trail Managing Agency or Organization:

(If the trail is designated an NRT, this name will appear on the certificate, along with the trail name. If more than one managing entity/organization is involved, please list each by name and include the corresponding contact information.)

Name of Trail Managing Agency or Organization:

Trail Manager’s Name:

Title/Position:

Mailing Address:

City, State, Zip code:

Street Address for FedEx Delivery (if different from Mailing Address):

City, State, Zip code:

Phone number:

Fax number:

Email address:

Website address:

Public Information Contact

(If different from trail managing agency/organization named above)

Name:

Title/Position:

Address:

City, State, Zip code:

Phone number:

Fax number:

Email address:

Website address:

Name and address to appear on the letter from the Secretary of the Interior if the trail is designated

(If different from trail manager's name and address – examples: department head, mayor, president of organization, etc.)

Name:

Title/Position:

Address:

City, State, Zip code:

Phone number:

Short Description of Trail:

(A quick “snapshot” for news releases, 35 words is the recommended maximum.)

Long Description of Trail:

(For use on the NRT website. 500-800 words recommended. State how your trail is nationally significant, what sets your trail apart from others. Highlight the trail's main features, emphasizing such factors as connection with other trails, health and fitness benefits, youth involvement, service to diverse communities and urban populations, innovation, quality of design and construction, maintenance plan, cost-effective management strategies, partnerships and support, outstanding resources, and even relevant art installations and interpretive facilities and services. As appropriate, describe the trail's history and evolution including concept, lay-out, partnerships, historic uses, political issues, and special events. Also describe current management direction: protection, safety program, maintenance, rules and regulations, signs, and associated recreation features.)

Trail Statistics

Designation

Please put an "X" next to all that apply.

- ☐ None/Unknown
- ☐ Millennium Trail
- ☐ Other National Designation (Please list.)

- ☐ State or local designations (Please list.)

Type

Please put an "X" next to all that apply.

- ☐ Greenway
- ☐ Rail-trail
- ☐ Backcountry
- ☐ Urban trail/bikeway
- ☐ Snow trail
- ☐ Water trail
- ☐ Nature or interpretive trail
- ☐ Equestrian trail
- ☐ Other (Please list)

Uses and Activities

Please mark "X" for Allowed.

Trail Uses

- ☐ Bicycling (on pavement)
- ☐ Bicycling-Mountain (off pavement)
- ☐ Boating-Motorized
- ☐ Boating-Non-motorized:
 - ☐ Canoeing
 - ☐ Kayaking
- ☐ Rafting
- ☐ Sailing
- ☐ Camping
- ☐ Camping-Backpacking
- ☐ Dogs-Mushing
- ☐ Dogs-On Leash
- ☐ Dogs-Off Leash

Other related activities

- ☐ Hang Gliding
- ☐ Hunting (any)
- ☐ Hunting-Archery
- ☐ Hunting-Big Game
- ☐ Hunting-Bird
- ☐ Hunting-Small Game
- ☐ Ice Skating
- ☐ Land Sailing

- ☐ Equestrian-Riding
- ☐ Equestrian-Pack Trips
- ☐ Equestrian-Other Stock
- ☐ Motorized Vehicles-ATV Riding
- ☐ Motorized Vehicles-Four-wheel drive
- ☐ Motorized Vehicles-Motorcycling
- ☐ Motorized Vehicles-OHV Driving
- ☐ Motorized Vehicles-Snowmobiling
- ☐ Pedestrian-Caving
- ☐ Pedestrian-Hiking/Walking/Running
- ☐ Roller/Inline Skating
- ☐ Skateboarding
- ☐ Snow-Skiing, Cross Country
- ☐ Snow-Snowshoeing
- ☐ Swimming
- ☐ Swimming-Diving/Snorkeling

- ☐ Rock Climbing
- ☐ Rockhounding
- ☐ Snow-Skiing, Downhill
- ☐ Snow-Snow Play, General
- ☐ Snow-Snowboarding
- ☐ Sand Sailing
- ☐ Wildlife Watch – Birds
- ☐ Wildlife Watching – Animals
- ☐ Other (Please list.)

Trail Features

Loop trail? ☐ Yes ☐ No

Lowest elevation: _____ feet

Highest elevation: _____ feet

Average width of tread or beaten path _____ inches

Minimum width of tread or beaten path _____ inches

Average grade of trail _____ %

Maximum grade of trail _____ %

Average cross-slope _____ %

Is user accessibility information available?

☐ Yes ☐ No

If yes, in what format:

☐ trailhead signage ☐ brochure ☐ web site ☐ other

Additional information:

Primary and Additional Surface Material

Please put an "X" next to all that apply. Place the letter "P" next to the material that is the primary surface of the trail.

☐ Asphalt

☐ Boardwalk

☐ Bituminous Treatment

☐ Bricks

☐ Concrete

☐ Crushed Rock, Compacted

☐ Grass or Vegetation

☐ Gravel

☐ Paver Blocks

☐ Puncheon

☐ Rock, Boulders

☐ Rock, Smooth

☐ Sand

☐ Snow or Ice

☐ Soil

☐ Soil, Compacted

☐ Soil with Stabilizer

☐ Water, Moving

☐ Water, Still

☐ Wood Chips

☐ Wood, Running Plank

Open Dates

☐ Open all year

☐ Open from _____ to _____

Seasonal Closures

Please indicate dates and reason for closure.

Times of Operation

☐ Open 24 hours

☐ Open from _____ to _____

Fees

Admission Yes No amount \$ _____

Parking fees Yes No amount \$ _____

Permit required Yes No amount \$ _____

Certification for Public Use

I hereby certify that: (1) I am duly authorized to represent the agency, organization or individual officially responsible for permitting trail use on this trail; (2) the trail is in existence and will be available for public use, to the best of my knowledge, for at least 10 consecutive years after designation; (3) the trail has been designed, constructed, and is maintained according to best management practices in keeping with the anticipated use(s); (4) the trail is in compliance with applicable land use plans and environmental laws; and (5) all affected land and water owners, public or private, have been notified and have given their written consent to this application. If this trail becomes permanently closed to public use, we will immediately notify the Department of the Interior's National Recreation Trail Coordinator.

Applicant Signature:

Agency or Organization:

Address:

Phone and e-mail:

Date of signature:

Checklist for submission. Did you remember to:

- ___ sign the application form?
- ___ include both short and long descriptions of your trail?
- ___ include letters of permission from all affected public and private land and water owners?
- ___ include a support letter or e-mail from the State Trails Administrator/Coordinator?
- ___ include adequate maps so someone unfamiliar with trail can find their way to it?
- ___ submit your application via e-mail by November 1?
- ___ ship your supplemental package by November 1?

Thank you!!!